



Here comes lightning

Inside a storm cloud, a strong wind blows around water droplets and hailstones. When they bump together it makes electricity that flashes down to the ground as lightning.

Lightning is very dangerous. It's best to stay indoors when there's a thunderstorm going on.

A bolt of lightning is a super-fast, super-hot flash of electricity.

What is thunder?

Thunder is the sound made by lightning tearing through the air. You hear it after you see the lightning because light is quicker than sound.



Count the seconds

Work out roughly how far away a storm is by counting the seconds between a flash of lightning and a clap of thunder. For every five seconds you count, the storm is about a mile away.